

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 235

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Meredith Ann Stokes.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Meredith Ann Stokes; and

WHEREAS, Meredith Stokes was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Clinton, Indiana, to Dora Brown and James Denzel Hartman on December 19, 1937, Mrs. Stokes moved to Illinois with her family while she was still young, and she graduated from Georgetown High School in 1955, working thereafter for Illinois Bell Telephone as a long-distance operator; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Stokes went on to earn a degree in elementary education from Eastern Illinois University, and utilizing the wealth of pedagogical knowledge gathered from experience and education, she masterfully taught in multiple Vermilion County schools, although she most fondly recalled her stints at Harrison Grade School, Vermilion Grove Grade School, and Wingard Grade School; and

WHEREAS, she married her high school sweetheart, Joseph D. Stokes, on January 1, 1956, a landmark occasion that would signal the beginning of over sixty-one joy-filled family years; and

WHEREAS, an avid bowler, Mrs. Stokes held offices in the Ridge Farm, Robinson, Rantoul, Effingham, and Danville bowling leagues, and displaying her remarkable skill and determination on myriad lanes, she won two 600 star jackets from Effingham and a 269 ring from K. Bowl; and

WHEREAS, she always appreciated traveling for tournaments, at both state and national levels, and she bowled in her last league, the Senior Citizen League at Lincoln Lanes, for over twenty years, concurrently creating abundant and abiding friendships; and

WHEREAS, her love of sports also extended to University of Illinois football and basketball, as well as the Chicago Cubs and Chicago Bears; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Stokes and her husband loved to expand their horizons through varied travels, including to Alaska, Hawaii, China, Germany, the Netherlands, and Panama, and they always enjoyed a cruise or a casino whenever the opportunity arose; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Stokes will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by her son, Gary Joe (Gayle Oberle) Stokes; her daughter, Jayne Ann (Danny) Dann; her granddaughter, Kayla Jo Dann; her great-granddaughter, Lyla Jayne; her sister, Judith (Jim) Erdmann; her sister and best friend, Janet Sue (Ray) Landskroner; special cousins, Barb (Jim) Morgan and Harold K. Hartman; and several nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, she was preceded in death by her husband, Joseph D. Stokes; her parents; and her brother, Gary Denzel Hartman; and

WHEREAS, Meredith Stokes leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Meredith Ann Stokes, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Stokes.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.